

World's first Jio TeleOS TV and evolving Smart TV market

A conversation with Thomson's **Avneet Singh Marwah**

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For years, the idea of India developing its own television operating system seemed improbable. The dominant narrative suggested that India lacked the R&D ecosystem and high-tech capabilities to create a homegrown OS. Global giants like Google and Apple had long dominated the smart TV space with their Android and proprietary platforms, making it even more challenging for an indigenous system to break through. Additionally, the immense capital investment, technical expertise, and software development capabilities required for such a project posed significant hurdles. Many believed that India would continue to rely on foreign technology for its smart TV ecosystem. However, the landscape began to shift as Indian companies started focusing on innovation and self-reliance.

But Thomson, in partnership with Jio, set out to change that perception and prove that India could compete on a global scale in the smart TV ecosystem. By leveraging Jio's robust technological infrastructure and Thomson's expertise in television manufacturing, the partnership is working to



Avneet Singh Marwah
CEO, SPPL

build an OS that is not only innovative but also deeply customized for Indian consumers. This initiative represents a major step toward technological self-reliance in India's consumer electronics industry.

Avneet Singh Marwah, CEO of SPPL (Super Plastronics Pvt Ltd), which manufactures Thomson TVs in India, recently shed light on this ambitious journey in an exclusive conversation.

Challenging the status quo: Why Jio TeleOS?

"A couple of years ago, the industry consensus was that India couldn't develop its own OS. The belief was that we lacked the ecosystem, R&D capabilities, and interest from global giants to build something truly

indigenous. That was our challenge," Marwah explains.

The collaboration with Jio started nearly three years ago, with a shared vision of building an OS that could compete with major players. According to Marwah, a significant hurdle was that big tech companies were hesitant to work within an Indian ecosystem due to the lack of scale. However, Jio's extensive network and growing influence changed the game.

"The turning point came when Netflix agreed to be part of this ecosystem—something they usually don't do with emerging operating systems. That endorsement encouraged more app developers to come on board, and today, 99.99% of India's most popular apps are certified and available on Jio TeleOS. This OS is built from the ground up to serve the Indian consumer better than any foreign alternatives."

Can Jio TeleOS compete with Android TVs?

With Android TVs dominating the smart TV market, questions about app ecosystem and compatibility are inevitable. But Marwah is confident in Jio TeleOS's capabilities.

"Every essential app is available. Our goal isn't just to compete with Google but to create an OS that caters specifically to Indian consumers. Jio TeleOS supports eight languages at launch – more than any other OS – and will expand to 16 languages in the coming year. This localization is crucial in a country with such diverse linguistic needs."

When asked, Avneet confirmed that Jio TeleOS supports sideloading of Android apps, ensuring flexibility for tech-savvy users.

How is Jio TeleOS different from Jio Set-Top Box OS?

While Jio already has an OS running on its set-top boxes, the version on Thomson TVs is more refined.

"It offers access to over 400 live TV channels and supports multiple